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Preface and Acknowledgements

This Volume on Sustainable Development and Inclusive Growth is an edited anthology where contributors from diverse backgrounds and professional disciplines have united in order to share their multi-cultural experiences and research insights to add both academic value and practitioner worldviews to the ongoing debates on the best practices of sustainable development strategies worldwide.

This multi-volume book series is a global project that seeks to make available a common platform to academicians, researchers, practitioners and activists alike so that they may in turn document their pluralist voices and specific choices of sustainable development interventions and initiatives based on their own local endeavours underpinned by global compulsions.

As the Editor of this book project I must admit that my initial motivation to plan and execute such an academic exercise was catalyzed during my visit to the Danish Institute of Rural Research and Development (IFUL) under the University of Southern Denmark in Esbjerg as a Guest Professor in 2007. I am grateful to Professor Flemming Just of IFUL and his colleagues who had inspired me considerably to edit this Volume.

It was at IFUL that I first hit upon the idea of designing a book series that would suitably try to incorporate lessons learnt and research methodologies of sustainable development projects (among other related issues and concerns such as the history, institutional arrangements, case studies, land reforms, decentralized governance, community mobilization, gender empowerment, indigenous technologies, multi-stakeholder dialogues and success stories) both from the North and South.

Sustainable development is an important concern at the policy and praxes levels, as this issue leads to related concerns like political

2

Strategy for Sustainable Rural Livelihoods: An Experience from EIRFP

BINAY KUMAR SAHAY

Introduction

The eastern plateau is one of the poorest regions in India, with a population of 30 million. Annual rainfall is 1,200-1,400 mm but erratic with 80-85 per cent falling during the monsoon (June-September). Drought spells are common even during the monsoon. Soils are shallow and acidic with poor fertility and low water-holding capacity. The average land-holdings are 1-2 hectares with few irrigation facilities. The land-holding is also declining due to rapid population growth.

Scheduled Tribes are the dominant inhabitants of the eastern plateau and the majority of them produce food for subsistence, but it is usually insufficient to meet their needs. In other words, the majority of the tribal habitants of eastern India are living in a situation of "hunger", a symptom of poverty. The causes of poverty among tribal communities include illness, social and economic exclusion, lack of voice, powerlessness, lack of representation, inadequate income and growth of human resources. In other words, food insecurity is the principal cause of hunger among these tribal poor people, or we can say that poor people cannot find the means of getting enough food, either through growing or buying it, especially during periods of hunger.

Strategy against "Hunger"

Strategies against poverty or the elimination of hunger are in response to a deepening understanding of its complexity. In the 1950s and 1960s, many viewed large investments in physical assets and infrastructure as a primary means of development. From the 1970s onward, awareness grew that physical assets are not enough and as important are health and education. The years of the 1980s saw another shift and poverty reduction was seen as a two-part strategy: promotion of labour-intensive growth through economic openness and investment in infrastructure, and providing basic service to poor people in health and education. Gradually in the 1990s, governance and institutions moved towards centre stage. These emphasized strategies for attacking poverty through promoting opportunities, facilitating empowerment, enhancing security and institutions, by ensuring participation of marginalized communities.

The concept of participation has been a part of an emancipatory discourse and practice in most of the developmental programmes for the last decade. Advocates of these concepts have claimed that they allow the representation of the most marginalized groups—women and poor people.

EIRFP – Project Context, Strategy and Objectives

The Eastern India Rainfed Farming Project (EIRFP) is located in the eastern plateau region of India, which covers a part of nine districts of three States: Jharkhand, Orissa and West Bengal. It was conceived in 1994-95 with the support of KRIBHCO[1], the Government of India and the Department for International Development (DFID) of the UK, and is now managed by the Gramin Vikas Trust[2].

The operational area of the project is Ranchi, Hazaribagh and Palamau districts of Jharkhand; Purulia, Birbhum and Midnapore districts of West Bengal; and Keonjhar and Dhenkenal districts of Orissa. These districts are amongst the poorest in these States and are managed at State level by GVT State Offices in Ranchi, Baripada and Purulia for Jharkhand, Orissa and West Bengal respectively. The Project Management Unit (PMU), situated at Ranchi (Jharkhand), is managing the project in all three States. The project received relatively intensive support from a team of consultants from the UK and DFID. The PMU is headed by a

Project Manager and has a team of technical and social science specialists who support Community Organizers placed in the field for the facilitation and implementation of work at village and cluster levels The project is working in 252 core villages grouped in 60 clusters. The Community Organizers are from agriculture, forestry, livestock, aquaculture and social science backgrounds, most with post-graduate qualifications in rural development. They are posted on to a cluster and 40 per cent are women.

The EIRFP is oriented toward its goal of improving the livelihoods of poor men and women of the eastern plateau using participatory approaches. It envisages participation, poverty and gender issues for the sustainable improvement of livelihoods in these areas.

RNR To Sustainable Livelihoods

EIRFP began its life in all three States as a "Participatory RNR[3] Management Project". It is a process project and facilitates a participatory planning process for the development of a village. In principle, local problems are identified and prioritized by villagers and they identify development options for implementation with the facilitation of project staff. The programme activities cover a range of farming system components, *e.g.,* crops, agro-forestry, wasteland development, soil and water conservation, aquaculture, livestock development and irrigation.

The Community Organizers are the key functionaries under the project and usually facilitate community members in the development of a plan of their village through natural resources management and institutional development. A *jankar*[4] (See Box 2.1) system has been evolved under the project for empowering the community and transferring and adopting technologies for improvement of sustainable livelihoods of deprived and marginalized people. They facilitate the process for the identification and selection of motivated men and women with interest in working for the benefit of a community or group. The project provides a series of training programmes and exposure visits in different areas of their interest and develops expertise and skills to make available it in and around villages and avoid dependency on outsiders for their development. A number of *jankars* in areas

Box 2.1: Role of Jankar

- Motivate the community to understand the needs for development;
- Initiate vision development of community to sustainable livelihoods development;
- Facilitate the community to participate in the process, *i.e.*, planning, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of the activity or programme;
- Adoption of suitable technologies by the community;
- Empowerment of the community and distribution of their roles and responsibilities in the development process;
- Linkage with GOs, NGOs and others for development and institution-building; and
- Dissemination of project approach to surrounding areas to achieve the wider goal.

Source: Empowering Community for Sustainable Livelihoods through Jankar System: An Experience from EIRFP by B.K. Sahay — *Kurukshetra* (India): A Journal Published by Department of Rural Development – Feb. 2002

of crops, trees, aquaculture and Soil and Water Conservation (SWC) have been identified and trained to facilitate and support the community within their villages.

In terms of the general approach, EIRFP has developed from a "provider" project of RNR technical know-how and financial support, to an enabler project which encourages villagers to autonomously address a wide range of livelihoods constraints. With the facilitation of the project, villagers have undertaken different farm and non-farm activities such as crops, trees, watershed management, livestock development and different income-generation activities. They have further scaled up the activities to increase their income and ensure their food security. The technology transfer has been made through training and exposure of the community and strengthening of the *jankar* system in each village. A series of community and *jankar* training has been organized for this purpose in and outside villages.

Over the years, it has kept these emphases but has changed in many respects—as the project reflected and learnt from its experiences in the field. The RNR focus remains because natural resources remain a main source of livelihood for people in the

project area, but it is not the only source. For example, even poor and landless people are mainly dependent on the village for fuel wood and fodder requirements, but have to rely upon their own wage labour for other requirements. The project has, therefore, had to develop a differentiated approach based on existing livelihoods strategies. It also seeks to get villagers themselves to address poverty in both social and economic dimensions—in particular the social exclusion and disempowerment of women. The work with people classified as BLAD[5] and women's empowerment are indicators of this change.

Gradually the project has realized that poverty among tribal poor people is strongly associated with lack of assets, or inability to use the assets for productive purposes. The assets in this context include human, social, natural, physical and financial capital (Careny, 1998). The project's participatory process leads to increased opportunities available to individuals, groups and communities for improvement and scaling up of assets for the sustainable improvement of their livelihoods.

Evolution of "Asset Based" Livelihoods Improvement Strategy

In the beginning, because of its priority, due importance was given under EIRFP to RNR issues using a participatory approach. With the facilitation of the project, villagers have undertaken different farm and non-farm activities to reduce the poverty or hunger situation. Gradually the project envisaged an holistic approach for sustainable improvement of livelihoods by mobilizing the existing five capitals (Tomar *et al.*, 2001) in and around villages. A brief description of project interventions centred on the existing capital for sustainable improvement of livelihoods is presented below.

(a) *Social Capital*

Social capital includes members of groups, castes, networking, relationships with institution, and access to wider institutions of society through which people pursuer their livelihoods. While working with tribal and marginalized sections of the community, project realized that a different set of coping strategies is required to get their participation. The project believed that, "Community participation in a development programme is not only ensuring the involvement of people in rendering financial assistance, giving one's own labour, or resource mobilization. In a true sense, participation of people can only be considered if they also have a role in the formulation, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of a programme."

The project places a strong emphasis on people's participation in planning, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of the activities using six steps under a participatory approach (Box 2.2).

Box 2.2: Participatory Approach to Development

Six Steps

- Rapport Building,
- Analysis of livelihoods and existing resources,
- Group Formation,
- Group Planning,
- Participatory Impact Monitoring, and
- Participatory Impact Evaluation.

Refer Flow Chart for Process of GVT under Participatory Approach.

To bring marginalized sections of the community—especially tribal groups and women into the mainstream of development—the project envisaged = creating an environment and level of understanding among the community to get their participation. The project has engaged Community Organizers to initiate the step of rapport-building. A strategy has been adopted for rapport-building and to ensure participation, *e.g.,* door to door visits, organizing meetings, distribution of vegetable seeds to enter into the kitchens of women.

Participatory Rural Appraisal (PRA) based on the five capitals of a sustainable livelihood has been used to analyse livelihoods (Sahay, 2003, Understanding) and to make the community realize about existing assets in and around the villages and further plan accordingly for the sustainable improvement of livelihoods.

The "group focus strategy" (Box 2.3) of the project provides social recognition, status and security, especially to the poorest, most marginalized and vulnerable groups including women, and minimizes gender discrimination and encourages them to get involved in the decision-making process.

Box 2.3: Group Focus Strategy – "Why"

- To get a common understanding of villagers problems and solve them,
- To make collective planning possible,
- To provide a mechanism for implementing activities which will create new assets or allow for better use of existing ones,
- To allow a sense of collective responsibilities and system of accountability to be set-up, and
- To provide a mechanism for sustainable livelihoods improvement.

Formation of groups, starting of income-generation activities by women's group, cash payments in hand to women under the SWC, are a few example under EIRFP centred on steps of a participatory approach to strengthen social capital. The strength of social capital is also reflected in the case study presented in Box 2.4.

Box 2.4: Shifting towards a Better Livelihood (A Case Study of a BLAD Household)

A little support can help overcome hurdles—no one realizes this more than Ravati Mahato of Khanasdih, Kaipara, West Bengal. A widow with leprosy—and with a marriageable daughter—she was discarded by society and left to struggle for her survival. It was at this juncture when EIRFP came forward and identified her as a BLAD household. Through a rapport-building process, EIRFP facilitated her to develop a strategy to fight the situation. She was given two goats with help from the project and two more goats were provided through a group fund by villagers who understood their community's social responsibilities. On realizing the urgent needs of fulfilling day-to-day requirements, additional support was given to Ravati in the form of short-term paddy dehusking activities that assured her regular income.

It is a different story now. The dehusking activity not only helped her survive, but she has built up a bank balance of Rs 2,000. She now has ten goats and established a business with access to the wider market. On the top of all this, she has been able to arrange her daughter's marriage. And she has been recognized by society. (*Sahay, 2003 " Poverty Ranking Tools….."*)

To avoid dependency, the project envisaged a participatory monitoring and evaluation system and involved the community and *jankars* in the process. The Strength, Weakness, Opportunity and Threat (SWOT) and Livelihood Asset Status Tracking (LAST) are tools used to strengthen the process.

(b) *Human Capital*

Skills, abilities, knowledge, willingness to work, entrepreneurship, good health and awareness are important assets for individuals or communities to improve their livelihoods. Enhancement of skills and capacity of men and women is one of the important interventions under the project. The community has been exposed and trained to develop an understanding on different aspects including the importance of a group and its management and about different technologies for adoption. The *jankar* system is the most suitable example of project initiation for the development of human assets (Box 2.5).

Box 2.5: Benefits of *Jankar* System

- Motivation of community becomes easier,
- Technology can easily be transferred to the community for its adoption,
- Confidence development among the group members to make their own plan and implement it effectively,
- The skill and capacity development among *jankars* reduces dependency,
- Helps to sustain activities and groups,
- Empowerment of women and deprived sections of the community for their active participation in decision-making,
- Dissemination becomes cost effective and sustainable, and
- Leads to integrated RNR development and improvement of livelihoods (*Sahay, 2002, Empowering…*).

An average of five *jankars* have been trained in one group and after five years of their functioning some have been identified as dissemination *jankars* to disseminate the process in surrounding villages. The project has initiated the process to link *jankars* with government programmes to get financial support to these self-motivated and trained *jankars* to ensure the sustainability of the system. The project has developed around 1,500 men and women *jankars*. Women *jankars* are working on a par with men *jankars* and are self-motivated and working without financial support from the project. Now the trained *Jankars* are being absorbed by NGOs, GOs and PRIs* to provide technical support for the implementation of their developmental programmes more effectively.

(c) *Financial Capital*

Financial assets available to people, *e.g.*, savings, credit and regular remittances, provide them with different livelihood options. The intervention under EIRFP includes facilitation of the member of groups for their contribution and generation of group funds to provide improved security and access to the credit at their door. With the facilitation of *jankars*, 1,498 groups have been formed, some exclusively men or women, and some mixed. They have generated a total of Rs. 23,307,903 in group funds. Group details are presented in Table 2.1.

Table 2.1: State-wise Group Details under EIRFP

States Covered	*Type of Groups*				*Group Fund (Rs.)*
	Male	*Female*	*Mixed*	*Total*	
Orissa	221	241	61	523	2,250,421
West Bengal	301	265	28	594	8,586,220
Jharkhand	205	133	43	381	9,258,199
Total	**727**	**639**	**132**	**1498**	**23,307,903**

The groups contribute part of their earnings from activities undertaken to the group fund, which has provided working capital to diversify their activities and scale up. Marginalized groups, including women, have easy access to credit to meet urgent subsistence, medical or emergency needs, and even some working capital to create productive assets for them. The facilitation and empowerment further leads to access to government programmes and financial institutions to play a wider role in their livelihoods improvement.

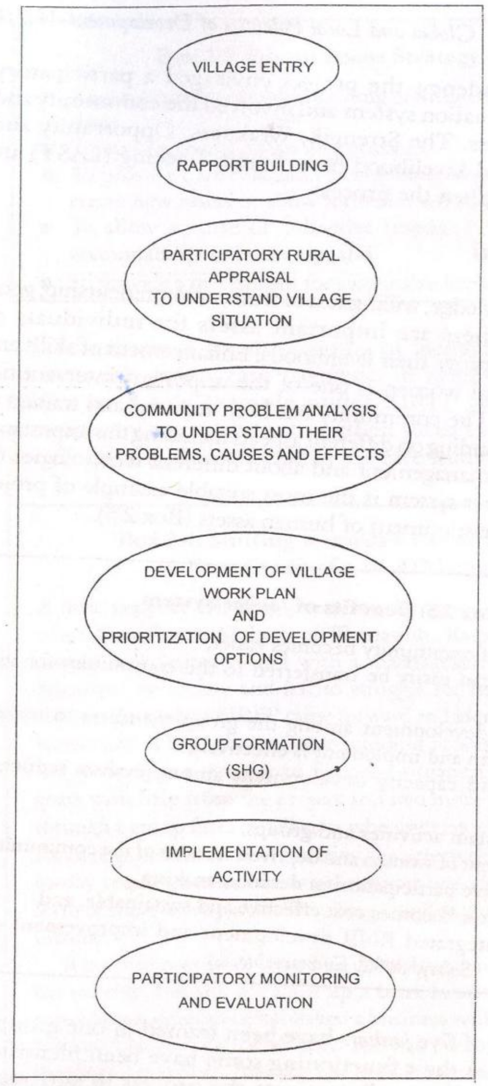
* PRIs—Panchayati Raj Institutions—a local level people's institution.

(d) *Natural Capital*

Natural resources—land, water, forest and the environment—are a gift of nature to humans to make them useful for their livelihoods. The project facilitated communities to undertake different farm and non-farm activities which have extended entitlement, even for marginalized sections of community, both men and women, as a productive asset directly or through sharing arrangement. The groups and *jankars* play a vital role in development of natural resources using their skill and financial strength for its optimum utilization through crops, trees and aquaculture activities based on these natural resources. It also leads to management of common property, *e.g.,* forest, land, water resources and wasteland, through collective effort. There is evidence of a 72 per cent increase in area through SWC measures and a 54 per cent increase in productivity and increase in gross cropped area with the introduction of High Yielding Varieties (HYV) cropped seed and its adoption. Sixty per cent of the wasteland area has been covered by agro-forestry. A number of households have also adopted different income generation activities. Group members have further diversified their farm-based activities to non-farm based activities to meet their requirements during hunger periods. Social, human and financial capital play a vital role in this direction and create an opportunity for using existing natural resources in and around the village to meet subsistence requirements during hunger situations.

(e) *Physical Capital*

Physical capital includes basic infrastructure and the production equipment and means which enable people to pursue their livelihoods. Collective action leads to development of physical assets as per the needs of a community, either through linkages with Government or with the support of people to get long-term benefit. Examples adopted in EIRFP villages include construction of community halls, link roads, renovation and excavation of ponds, installation of hand and irrigation pumps.



Flow Chart 2.1: Participatory Process Followed in Project Villages

Box 2.6: Project Interventions and Impact on Different Capital

Asset/Capital	Objective	Types of Interventions	Outcomes/Impact
1. Social Capital	More Supportive Social Environment	■ Rapport building and realization of existing capital with in village. ■ Identification and facilitation of the deprived including BLAD. ■ Facilitation for collective action/group effort. ■ Group formation and its strengthening. ■ Promotion of male, female and mixed group. ■ Gender Sensitization. ■ Facilitation to the women for women liking activities for their participation in decision making. ■ Payment in hand against SWC works. ■ Promotion of activities for inclusion of BLAD.	■ 53 per cent members of groups are from deficit category and 47 per cent women are the members of group formed and 72 per cent groups have strong saving and credit system. ■ Work plan for village developed. ■ Women are empowered and 47% are trained as *jankar* and working as par men. ■ 79 per cent group members are participating in decision-making process and development of village work plan.
2. Human Capital	Awareness, skill, capacity-building and transfer of technology for sustainable livelihoods.	■ A series of infield training and exposure organized on different components. ■ Identification of *jankar* on different components their skill upgradation on different components. ■ Need-based training and scaling up of the activities and its diversification. ■ Training of community, *jankar* on groups, its management and monitoring and evaluation of activities.	■ Introduction and adoption of *jankar* system. ■ Formation, development and strengthening of groups. ■ Dissemination of process and approaches by dissemination *jankar*. ■ Recognition and hiring of service of *jankar* by different organisation including PRI/Govt. ■ Increase in technical know-how. ■ More communication. ■ Higher degree of awareness among the members. ■ Increase in confidence. ■ More children attending School.

(*Contd.*)

Box 2.6—Contd.

Asset/Capital	Objective	Types of Interventions	Outcomes/Impact
3. Financial Capital	Access to Financial Resources	■ Facilitation for small saving in-group funds. ■ Group fund development and its management. ■ Linkages with financial institution and Government programmes.	■ Rise in thrift habit. ■ Rise in source of loan ■ Group fund generated ■ Improved security to the deprived ■ Credit at door.
4. Natural Capital	Access to and Better Management of Natural Resources.	■ Non-farm and farm activities undertaken by groups based on existing natural resources in and around the villages. ■ Management of common property i.e. forest, land, water resources, wasteland etc. through collective effort. ■ Introduction of technology for its adoption to improve agricultural services.	■ 72 per cent increase in area through SWC measure. ■ 54 per cent increase in productivity and increase in gross cropped area with the introduction of HYV cropped seed and its adoption. ■ 60 per cent of the waste land area has been covered by agro-forestry.
5. Physical Capital	Access to Facilities and Infrastructure.	■ Introduction of improved tools as per requirements. ■ Creation of infrastructure as per need of community with participation of group's members. ■ Linking the groups with Government programmes for improved infrastructure.	■ More well/hand pumps for drinking purpose created. ■ Increase in irrigation facilities in and around the village. ■ Improved housing condition of the deprived community in the villages.

Box 2.7: Transforming Livelihoods of Poors for Achieving Sustainability

CASE [I]

Rajhar is one of the village adopted by EIRFP—a tribal dominated village situated in Hazaribagh district of Jharkhand—spell a remote, poorest, traditional and habitant of Mahato and ST community with poor infrastructure facility in the village. The livelihoods of these tribes depends upon the forest and mono-cropping practice.

One of the group "Krishi Club" of Rajhar cluster was identified by EIRFP for pilot project to promote micro-finance/micro enterprise, leads the group to undertake a poultry activity on their upgradation of skill on poultry farming. The project facilitated the group for linkage with Block and Bank. After getting assurance from a Bank, the group constructed a poultry house by using their contribution in cash and labour and further got a loan of Rs. 50,000 to start a poultry business and are running successfully after repayment of Bank loan out of the income from it.

Now the poultry business has become a primary source of income and it leads to undertake various other activities like paddy dehusking, goatary, mate making, sattu making etc. in groups. The skill and capacity of the member have improved accordingly and are now playing key role on transforming their livelihoods for sustainable development.

CASE [II]

Construction of a check dam in Muretha village of Bagda cluster is another example of creating income generation opportunity by EIRFP through effective use of natural resource. The Muretha village is predominated by scheduled caste. The topography of village is highly undulated with sandy soil. One perennial *nala* exist in the village rarely used for irrigation purpose. The livelihoods of the families in surrounding village were dependent on mono-cropping.

Consequently the villagers decided for the construction of a check dam on the *nala* so that they can make an effective use of it. An intensive plan was developed by villagers with the support of project staff to develop the area on watershed basis. The construction of check dam completed in 1999 and 45 ha. land has been treated by field bund with the support of project. The project has also provided support in installation of lift irrigation to optimized the benefits.

(Contd.)

Box 2.7—Contd.

The scenario has been now completely changed. The group members are taking various crops covering 70 acres on individual/ community basis and are practicing double crops including the marketable vegetable for cash generation.

Thus the participatory process adopted by the project leads a step forward for transformation of the livelihoods even of the deprived men and women.

Source: GVT NEWs April–June 2002.

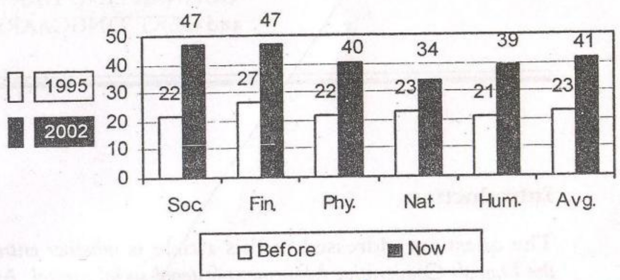
6. Impact of Interventions under EIRFP

The EIRFP envisaged an holistic approach to ensure sustainable improvement in livelihoods, especially in marginalized section of the community. The processes adopted have their epicentre in social and human capitals to achieve their goal. The project has used capital-based PRA for helping the community realize about existing assets in and around the villages and also to facilitate the community in well-being ranking (Sahay, 2003, Tools....) in BLAD, deficit, self-sufficient and surplus category, and to ensure the participation of target groups in the process of development. Strengthening of social and human capital leads toward generation of financial capital through small savings within the group. The upgrading of skills through training, exposure and the introduction of technology facilitate group members in judicious use of existing natural resource such as land, water and forest to ensure food security. The impact of project interventions is being reflected in case studies presented below:

Empowerment and participation in decision-making processes has also ensured creation of infrastructure by establishing long-term linkages with Government programmes. Gradually the effort leads toward institutional sustainability with more knowledge, capacity, confidence, greater skill, financial support and further greater access to Government programmes. The initiative has also been taken to replicate the learning to other organizations, NGOs, GOs, PRIs and FIs to ensure its sustainability.

EIRFP has also taken an initiative to quantify the achievements of project interventions. It has evolved a "LAST"[6] tool to measure the degree of improvement made in livelihoods components. The LAST tool has been developed using a participatory process and is based on the criteria of the five capitals. The findings are measured on a matrix scale indicating degree of improvement made in a limited time span. The results (Box 2.8) show that effort in community involvement and social issues seem to have a direct impact on livelihoods. In five-year intervals of project interventions, social and human capital has been increased by 114 per cent and 83 per cent, whereas financial and natural capital have grown by 77 per cent and 69 per cent. The results also reflected a shift of deficit to self-sufficient by 23 per cent, 96 per cent of vulnerable—BLAD shows some improvement of which 71 per cent have moved to the next category.

Box 2.8: Livelihoods in Project (Overall Avg.)



The emerging organizational structure of the project in the form of the Gramin Vikas Trust—a combination of Government system and flexibility in work as an NGO—for the management of EIRFP, shows the process using a participatory approach and the *jankar* system are playing vital roles under the project for sustainable improvement in livelihoods.

Conclusions

The livelihood profile of the different economic categories identified by the project through poverty ranking show that each of these categories has a different set of coping strategies to deal with the situation of scarcity and distress. Very poor or lower deficit households migrate over a long period of time or are engaged in low return activities such as head loading and sale of fuel-wood.

People in the BLAD category in particular live under conditions of malnourishment and distress. These households do not get access to easy loans for consumption purposes to deal with the distress situations.

The project realized that poverty is strongly associated with lack of assets or inability to use assets for productive purposes and scaling up. The project strategy encouraged the community in their realization of the existing five capitals for the improvement of their livelihoods. The improvement in social and human capital increased the opportunities available for the sustainable improvement in livelihoods. This has been reflected through qualitative indicators of change such as empowerment processes, social recognition, confidence among deprived sections and women, scaling up of different capital, capacity and dealing with outside resources, over the quantitative targets leading toward sustainable improvement of livelihoods.

NOTES

1. KRIBHCO – Krishak Bharati Cooperative Limited, a cooperative under the Ministry of Fertilizer, Government of India.
2. Gramin Vikas Trust (GVT) – An organisation established and supported by KRIBHCO, GOI and DFID.
3. RNR is Renewable Natural Resources.
4. A *jankar* is a para-professional, a female or male member of the community, who serves as an internal catalyst, information bank, service provider, trainer, disseminator and innovator (Source: *Kurukshetra* (India), 2002).
5. BLAD – Between Life and Death category of household, *i.e.,* widow, handicapped, socially or mentally handicapped.
6. LAST: Livelihoods Asset Status Tracking.

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Abbreviations

BLAD	: Between Life and Death
DFID	: Department for International Development
EIRFP	: Eastern India Rainfed Farming Project
Fls	: Financial Institutions
GVT	: Gamin Vikas Trust
Gos	: Government
HYV	: High Yielding Varieties
KRIBHCO	: Krishak Bharati Cooperatives Limited
LAST	: Livelihood Asset Tracking
NGO	: Non Governmental Organization
PRA	: Participatory Rural Appraisal
PMU	: Project Management Unit
PRI	: Panchayat Raj Institution
RNR	: Renewal Natural Resource
SHG	: Self Help Group
SWC	: Soil and Water Conservation
SWOT	: Strength Weakness Opportunity and Threat
UK	: United Kingdom